



LED bulbs function as turning signals, and are controlled by buttons on the bicycle's handlebars.

HEADGEAR

Helmets provide vital protection for a cyclist's head in case of accidents. The first modern helmet, made of light, tough plastic foam, was introduced in the 1970s. Helmets have come a long way since then—the Lumos (left) is a smart helmet with its own signals and brake lights, just like a car.

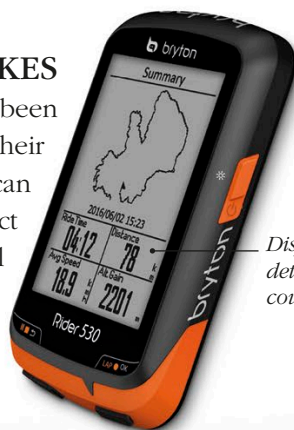


REFLECTIVE JACKETS

In traffic, a cyclist's life depends on being seen. They are often advised to wear reflective or high-visibility jackets, which glow in low light. Fluorescent jackets glow in bright colors by converting invisible UV light into visible light. After dark, retro-reflective strips reflect light from car headlights.

SMART BIKES

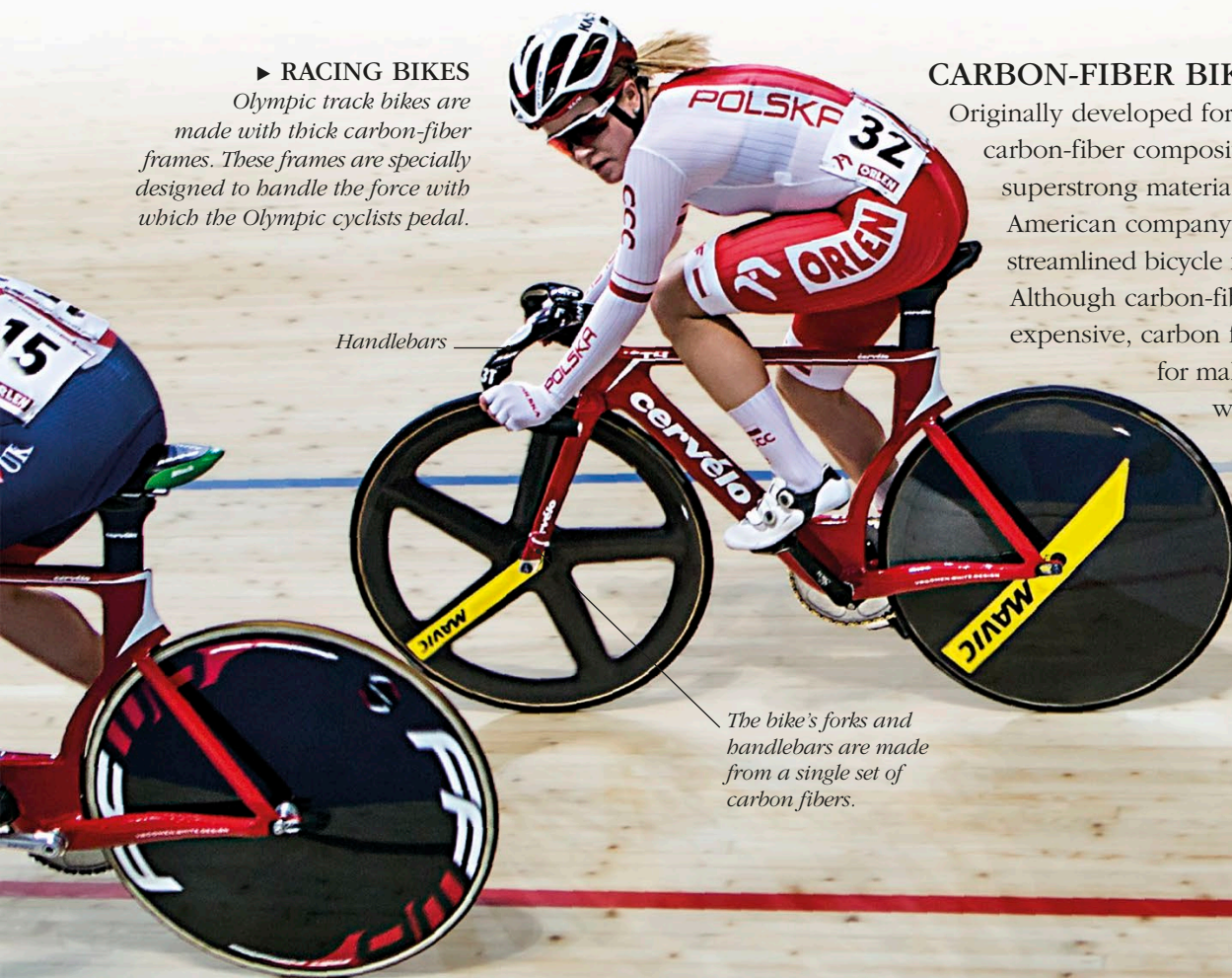
Since the late 1990s, cyclists have been able to attach mini-computers to their bicycles to make them "smart." These can do anything from telling cyclists their exact position, speed, and route using Global Positioning System (GPS) satellites to changing gear automatically in response to conditions.



Display provides details of the course taken.

► RACING BIKES

Olympic track bikes are made with thick carbon-fiber frames. These frames are specially designed to handle the force with which the Olympic cyclists pedal.



Handlebars

The bike's forks and handlebars are made from a single set of carbon fibers.

CARBON-FIBER BIKES

Originally developed for the space industry, carbon-fiber composites are superlight, superstrong materials. In 1996, the American company Kestrel made a streamlined bicycle frame from carbon. Although carbon-fiber frames are expensive, carbon fiber is now used for making the frames—as well as the wheels—of all track racing bikes, and also for many road bikes.